

Thread - 2026-02-10

<https://x.com/RiikonenMarko/status/2021113192122855847>

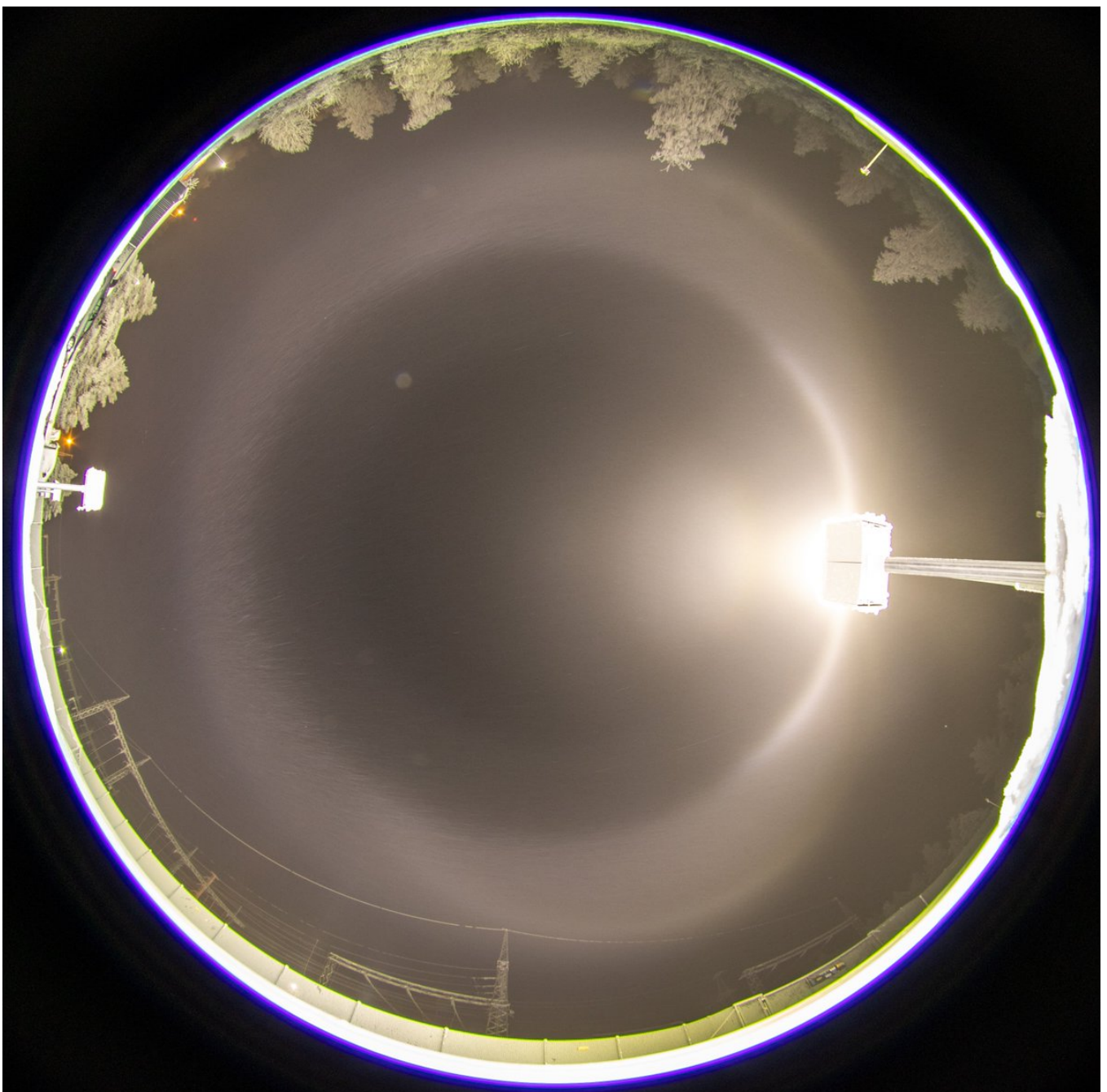
1/10 - 2026-02-10 06:45 UTC

9/10 Feb 2026, Rovaniemi. At the coalface from 9 to 7. Was using at one point simultaneously three lights and three cameras. Sampled crystals. Ice fog was present constantly, occasionally intensifying with massive plate. Moilanen arc visible non-stop.

Here I have Canon underneath a double parking lot light at Valajaskoski hydroelectric plant. This is a single image, have plenty to stack.

Temp dropped from -16 C to -23 C at railway station, Apukka from -18 C to -28 C. The min was reached at 6 am, then it started warming because clouds came in.

Even if it clears up, I'll skip daytime. Gotta sleep.



2/10 - 2026-02-10 16:21 UTC

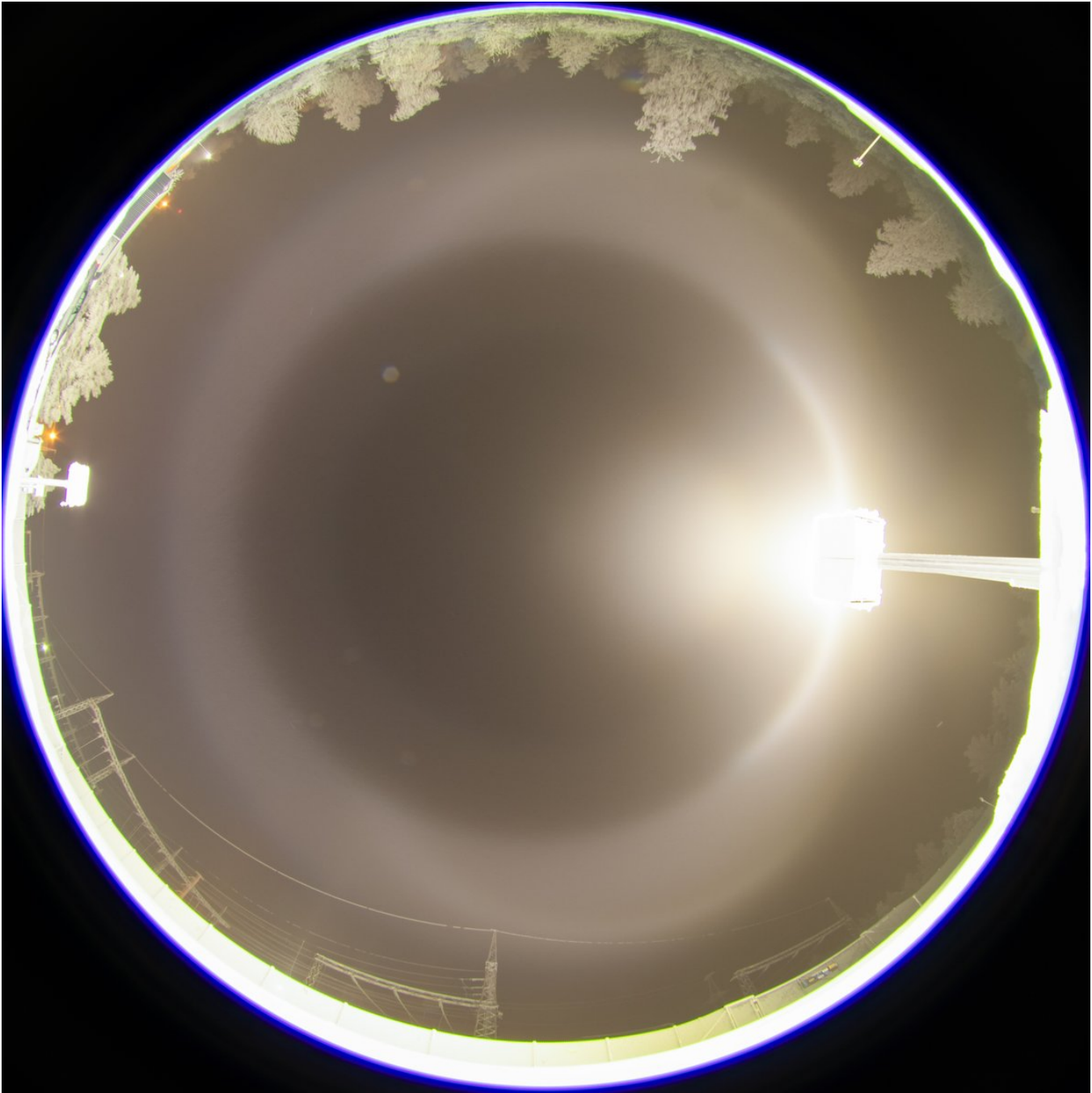
9/10 Feb 2026, Rovaniemi. 19 x 13s, the very best stage of the second plate intensification swarm, and which I didn't blunder by overexposing. My reason to concentrate on this was to get more data on the 58° zenith circle. It seems to have no outright red visible, only blue, therefore being solely a blue edge effect from snow reflection, an "integrated countesun" (explanation suggested by Lefaudeux), no arc from 90° prism refraction involved.

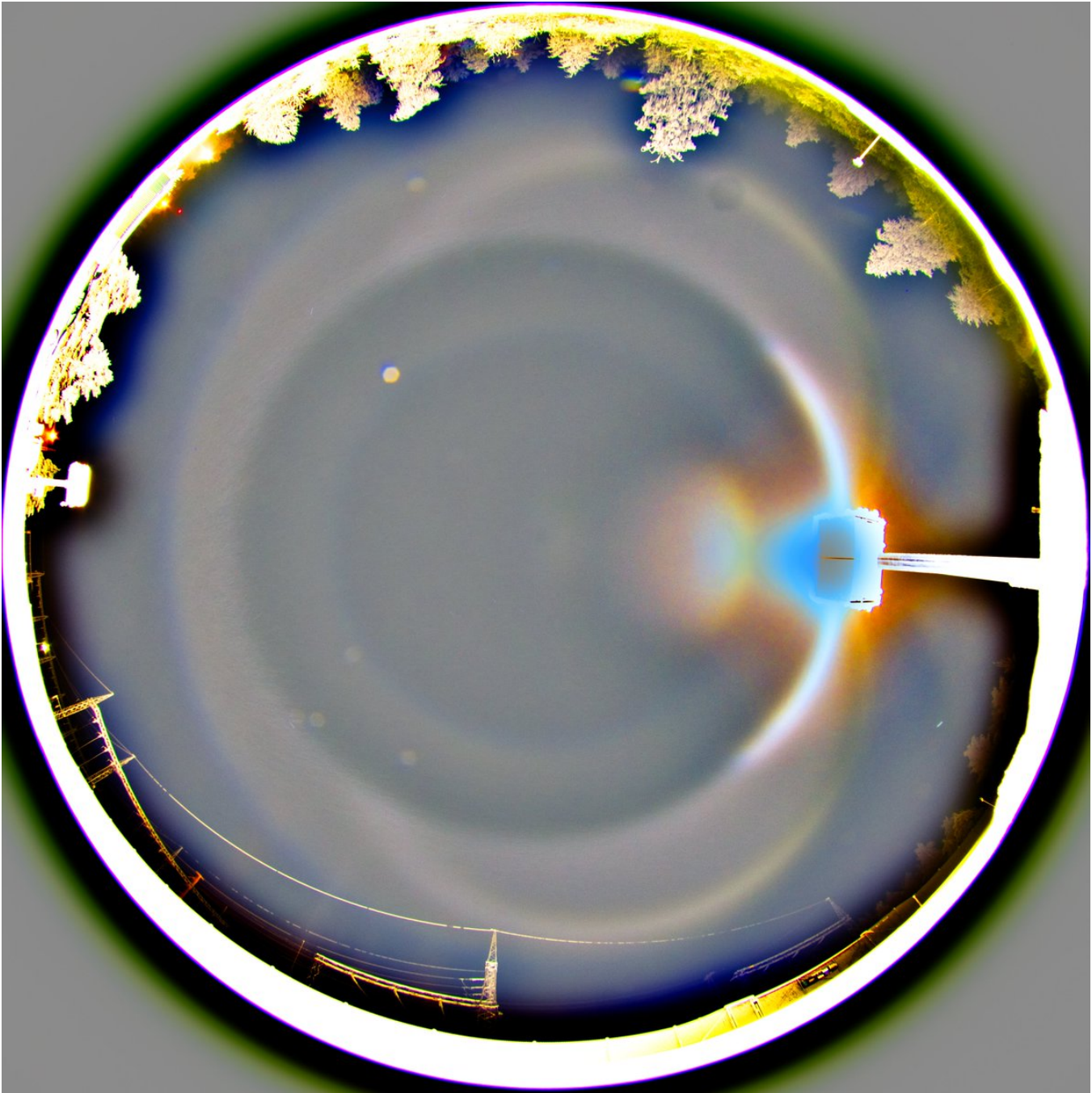
No big lights in the neighborhood, the only lights are pretty much what you see to the right of the image, quite far away on a level ground and well shaded against upwards light, giving only the meagrest pillars, if at all. So this display was solely caused by the double parking lot flood. Very intense – like daytime underneath.

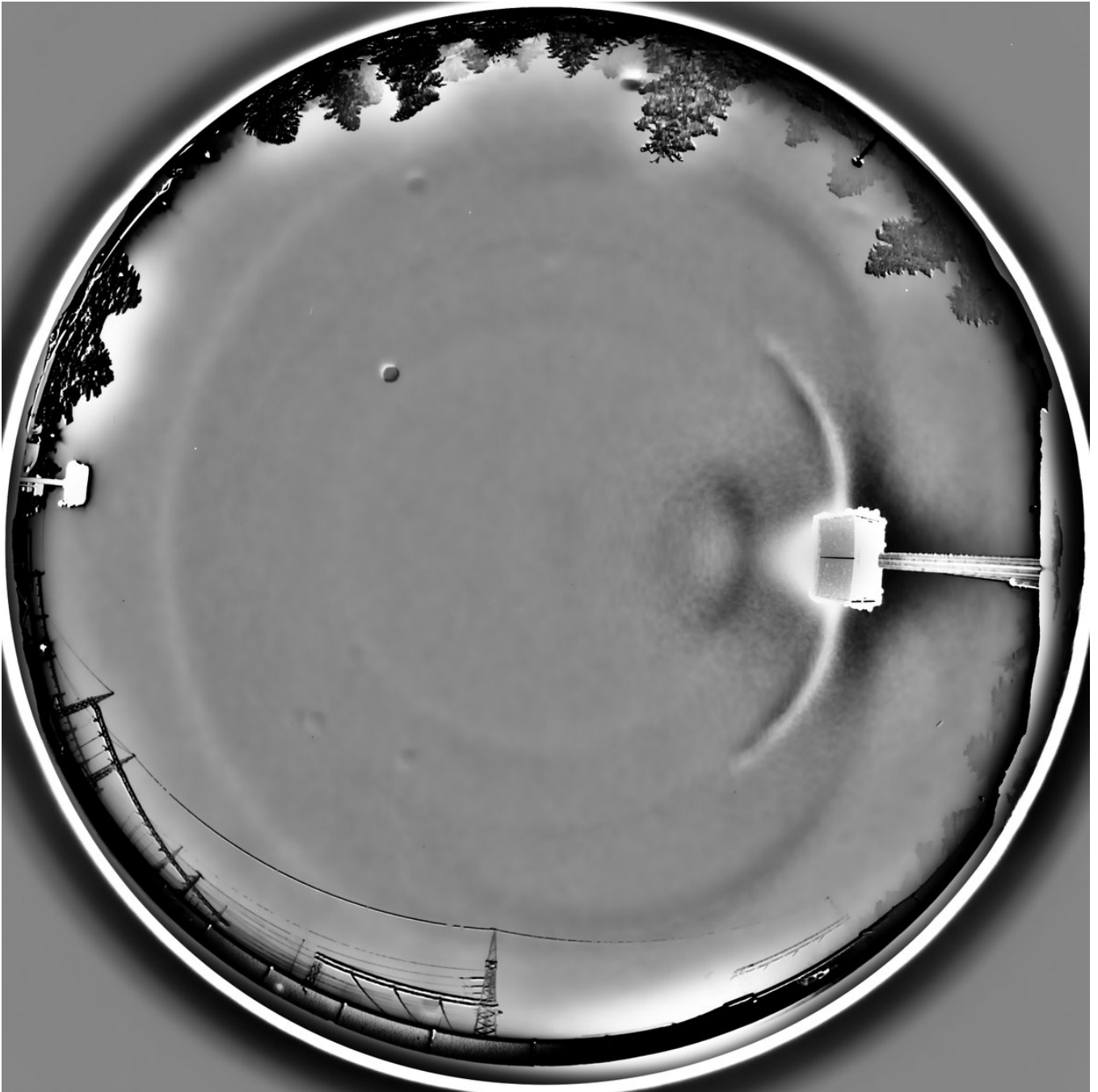
Another blue edge effect is visible on the parhelic circle outer edge. Zenith arc is abnormally close to the light because of the high elevation. And of course there are the distinct 120° parhelia curving below the light level. They look reddish, so are we talking about the common red rim effect here?

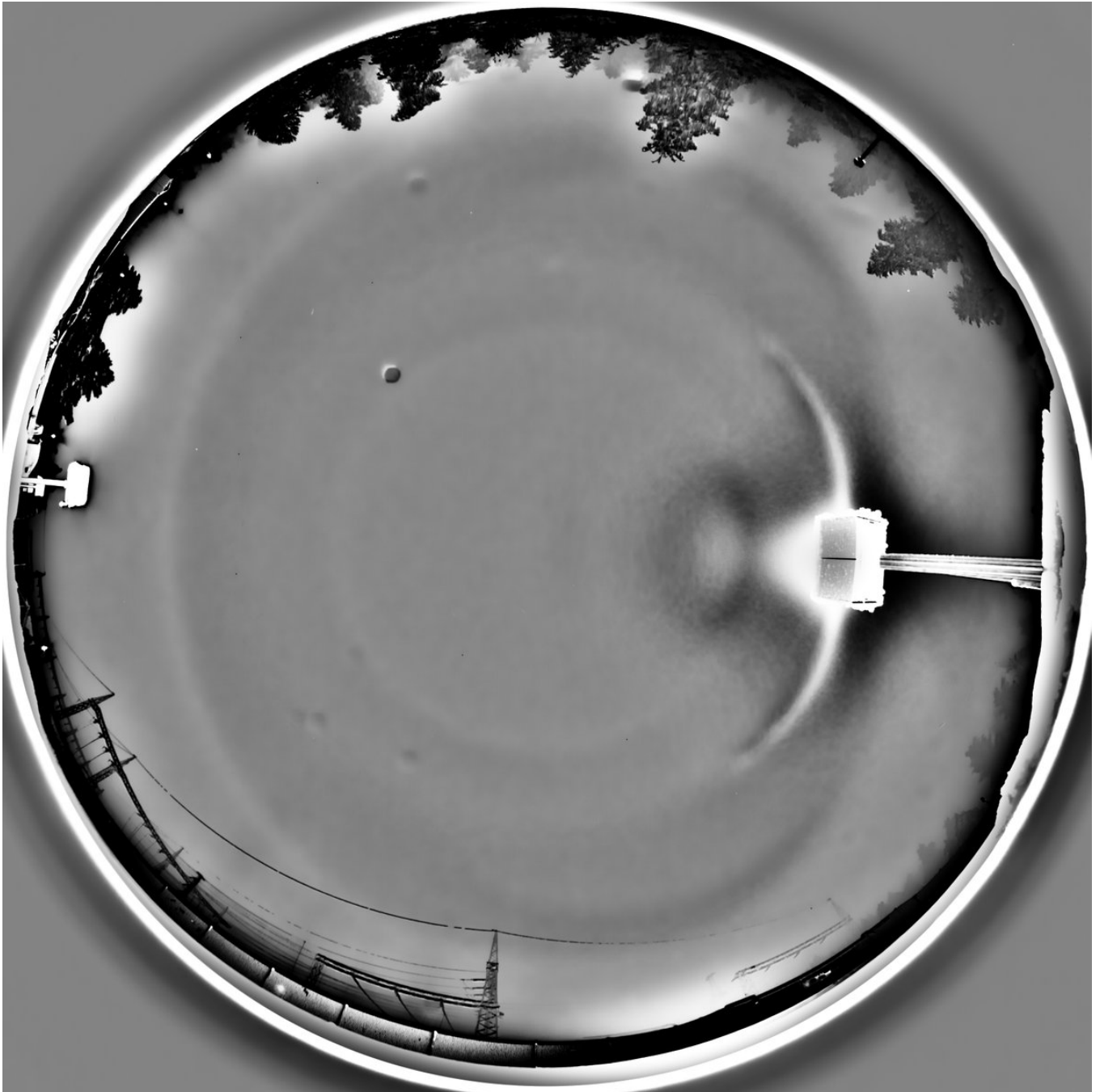
The spot at the zenith bothers me a bit. Zenith spot should be present, but am I seeing color in it?

The third image is b-r, fourth g-r.









3/10 - 2026-02-10 16:54 UTC

9/10 Feb 2026, Rovaniemi. The operation. There was this row of electric outlets for car motor heating and they were tailor made to act as a blocker. It's almost like the place was designed for divergent halo photography. I might nag about there being two lights on that pole instead of one. But then they were pointing symmetrically with respect to the line of the electric outlets – yeah, they had thought about that, too. I am now looking forward to get massive column and Parry under this light.







4/10 - 2026-02-14 11:45 UTC

9/10 Feb 2026, Rovaniemi. Experimenting on the role of snow reflection in making the 58° zenith circle.

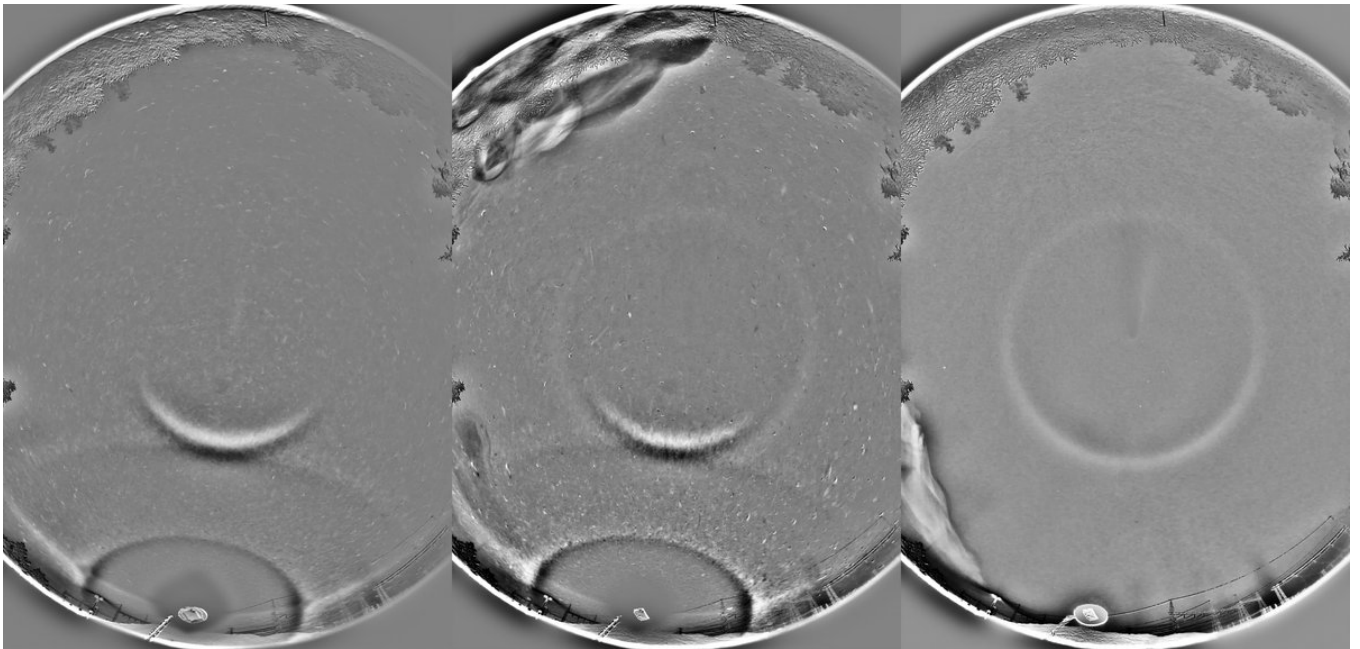
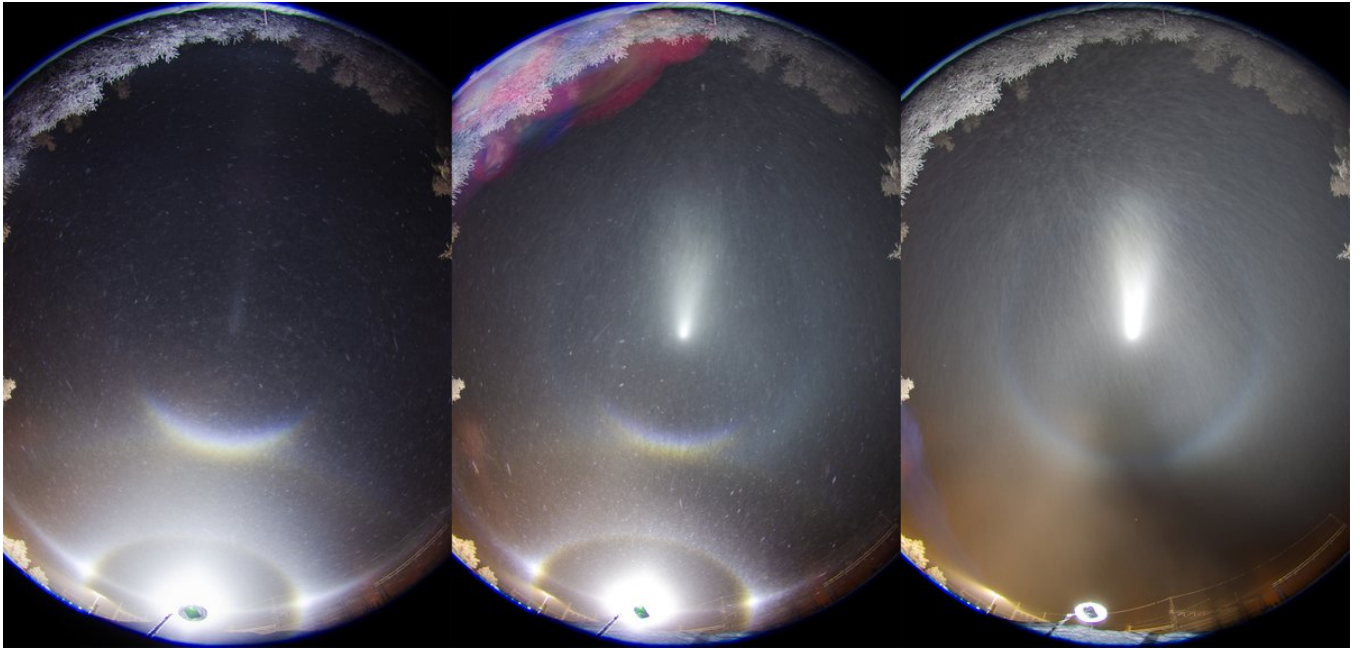
Left: Javelot Turbo on top of a mound.

Middle: + HID pointing down on snow next to camera

Right: - JT

The third image shows HID next to camera.

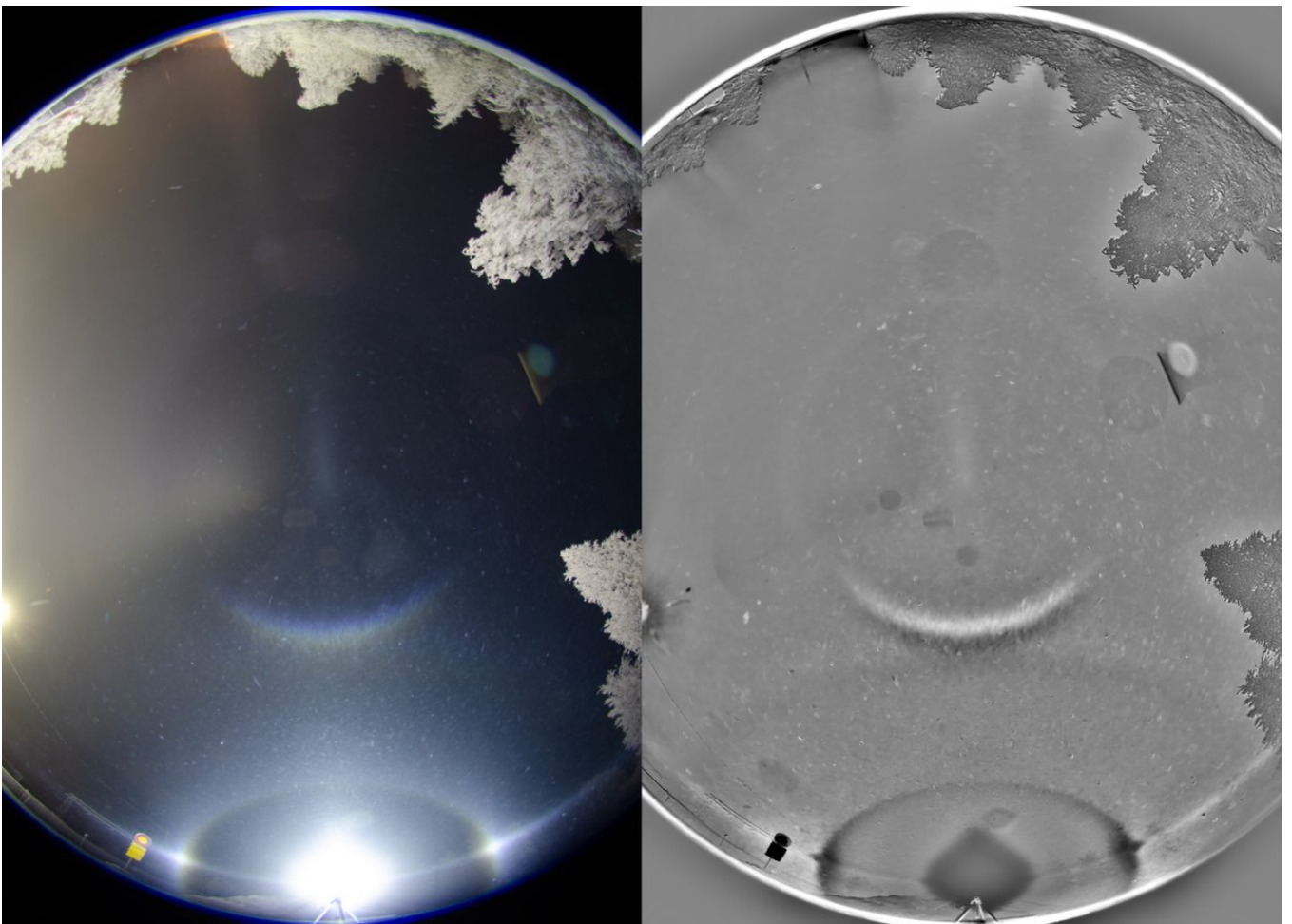
No Dufay seem to be present – so this was not a top notch display. It is noteworthy that in the JT-only set-up the hot spot on snow behind the camera is not making 58° zenith circle – or is there a segment of it underneath za? I have also photos where camera was on the ground in the middle of the hot spot and the 58° circle is weakly visible, as shown by the next post.





5/10 - 2026-02-14 11:50 UTC

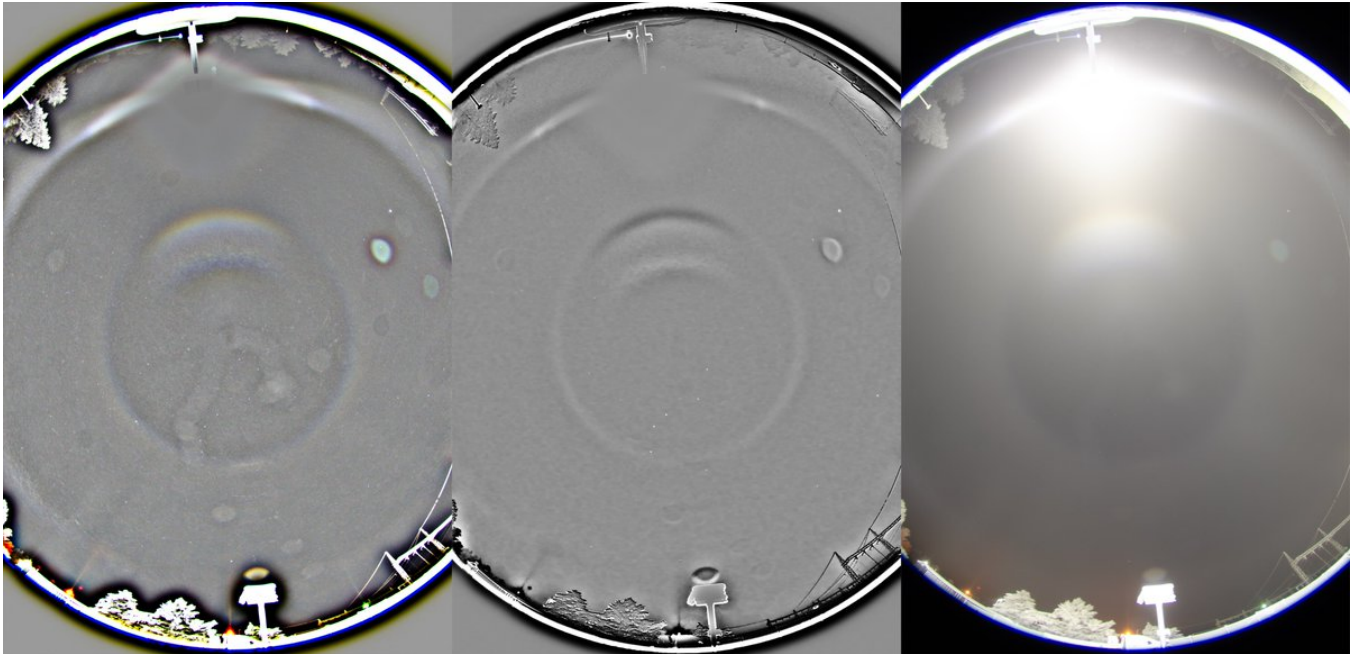
9/10 Feb 2026, Rovaniemi. Camera in the middle of the JT hot spot made the 58° zenith circle. At least that's what I think it is, it seems to be larger than Dufay would be.



6/10 - 2026-02-14 12:11 UTC

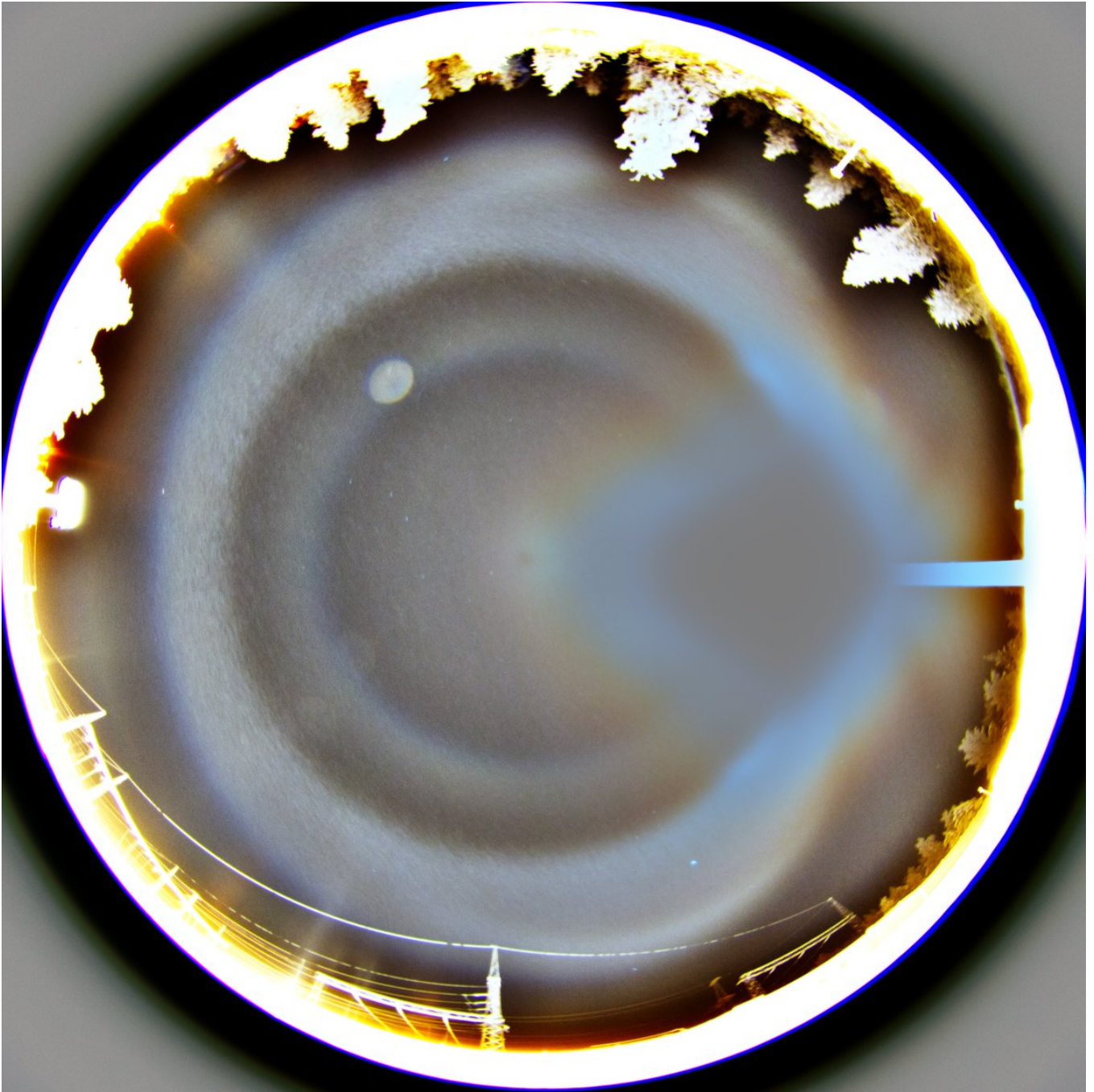
9/10 Feb 2026, Rovaniemi. I had another camera for a while behind the second electric outlet pole from the parking lot light. What's wrong with the zenith arc? Simultaneously there was also camera behind the first pole as well as in the Javelot Turbo beam, however, the former images are overexposed while the latter are rather underexposed.

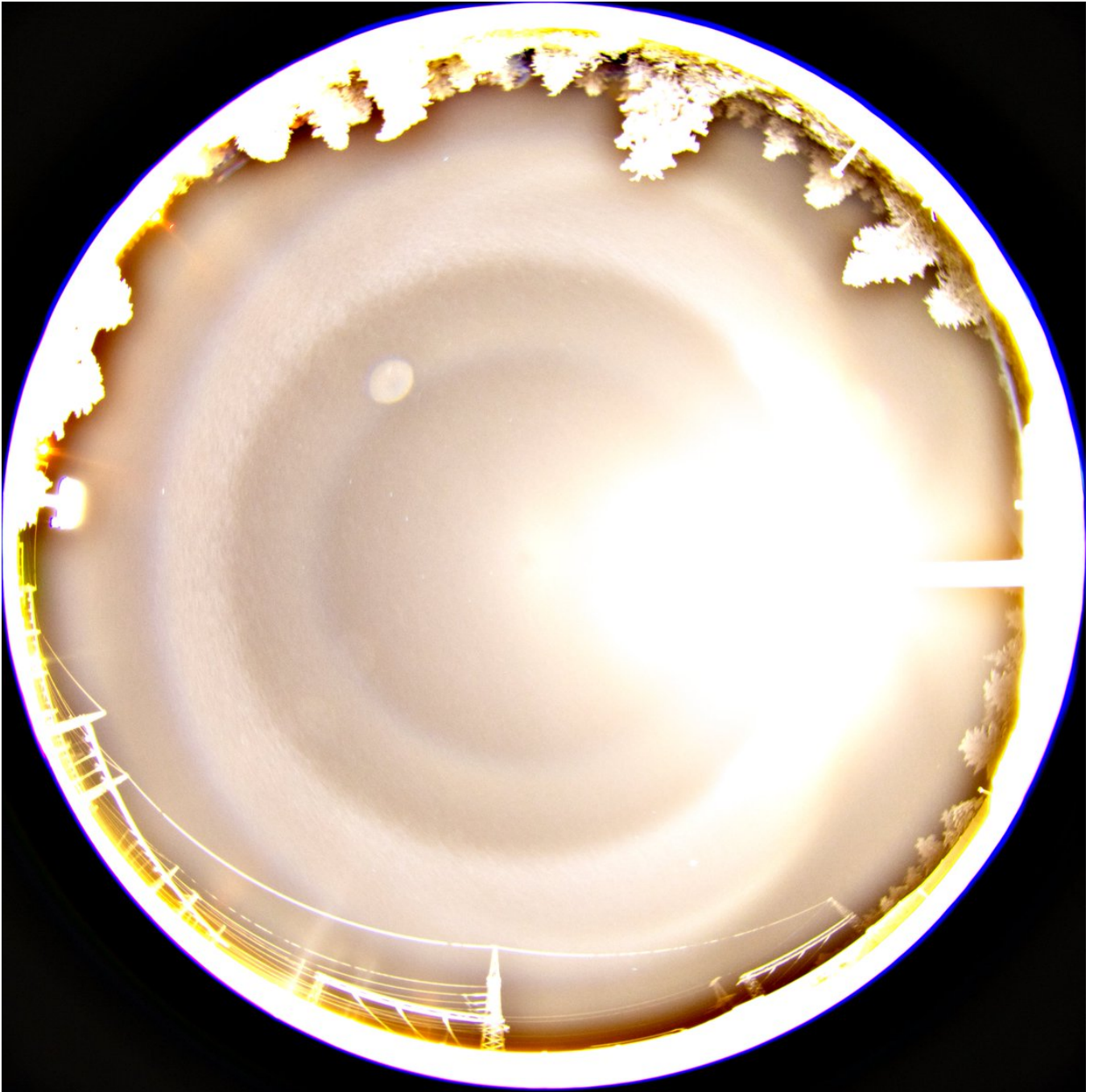
16 bit tiff: <https://t.co/uPKOhCV2TZ>

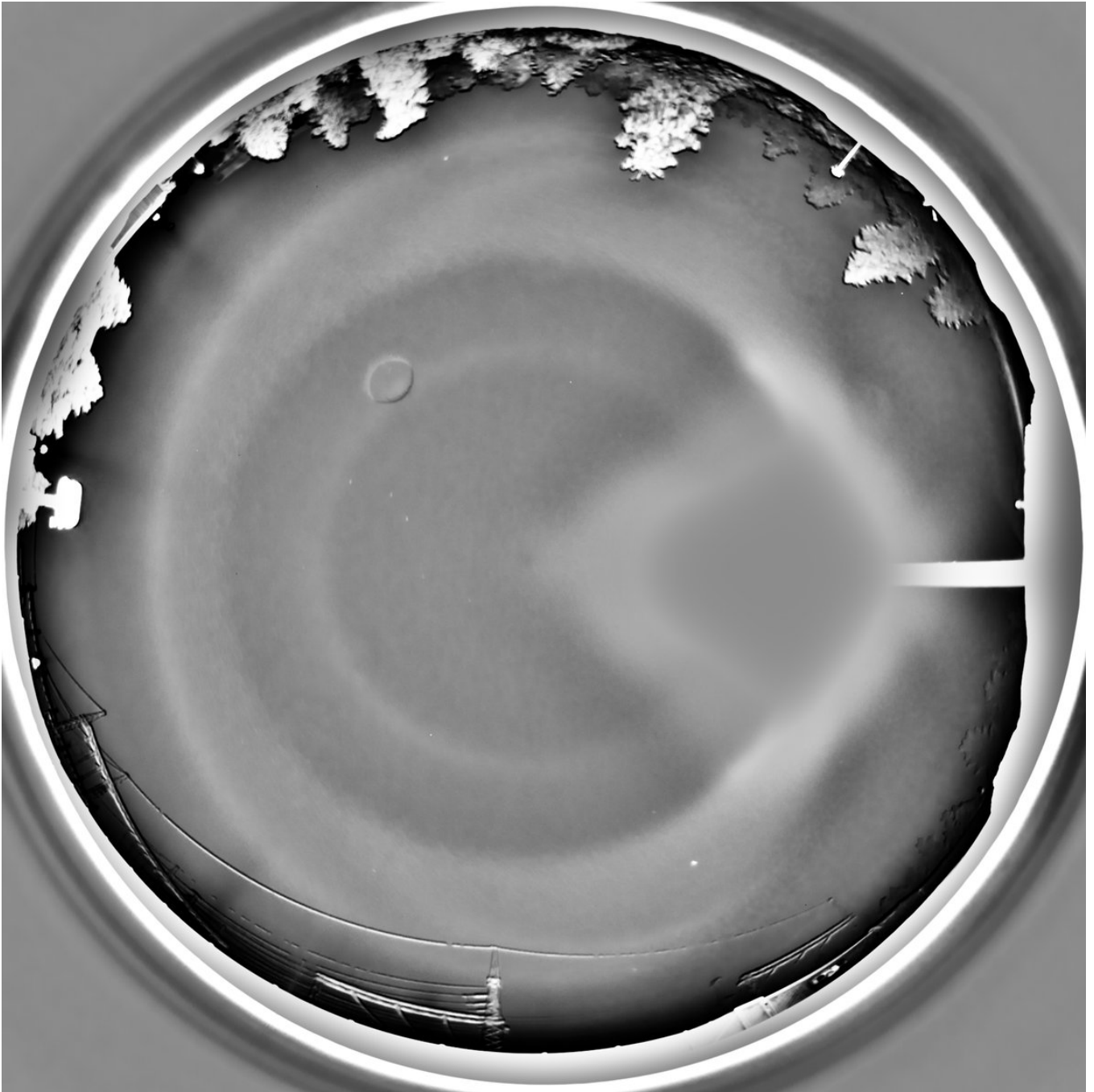


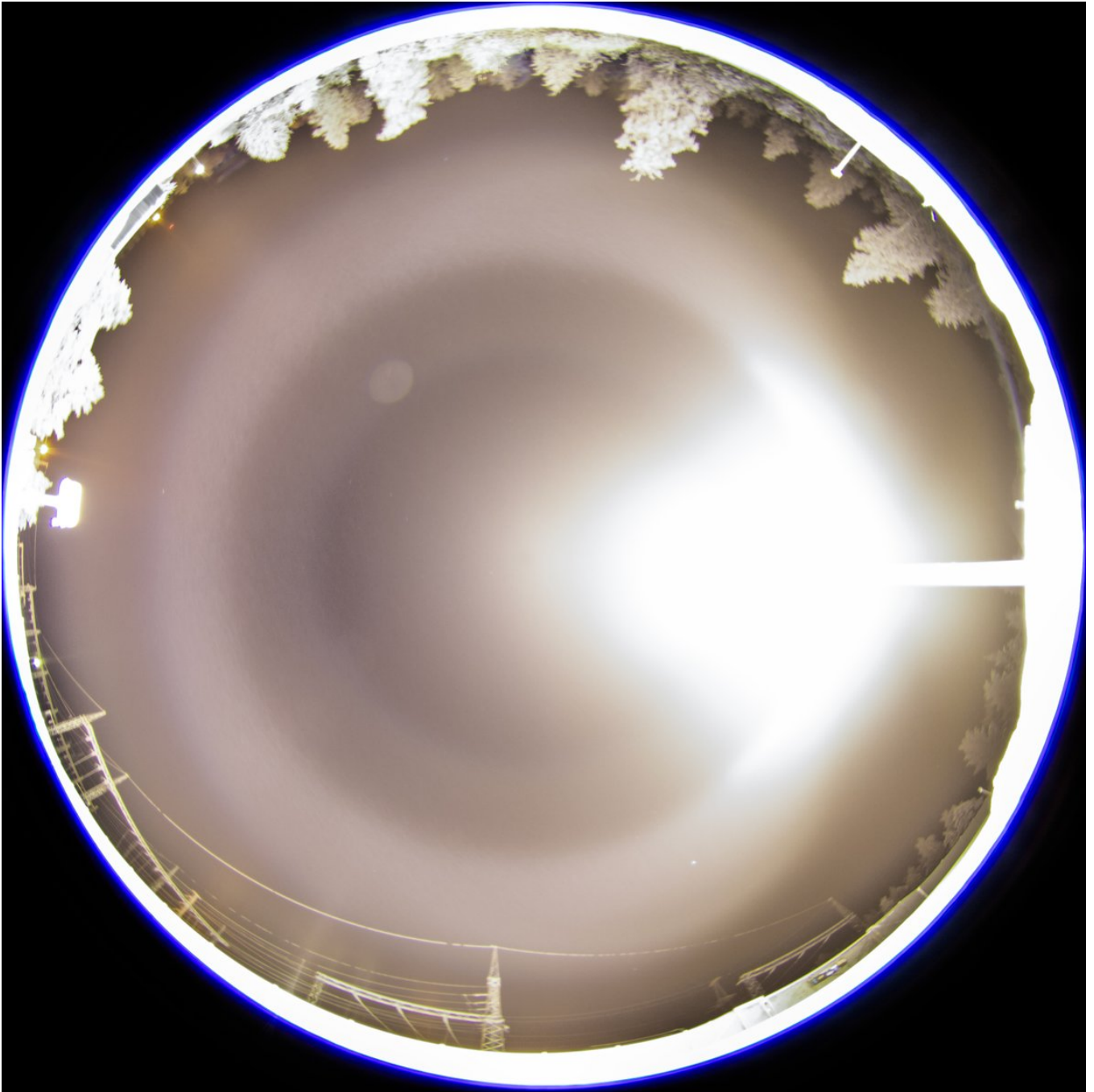
7/10 - 2026-02-14 13:09 UTC

9/10 Feb 2026, Rovaniemi. From the overexposed early set, 3 x 30s. These are the very first photos I took under the flood.





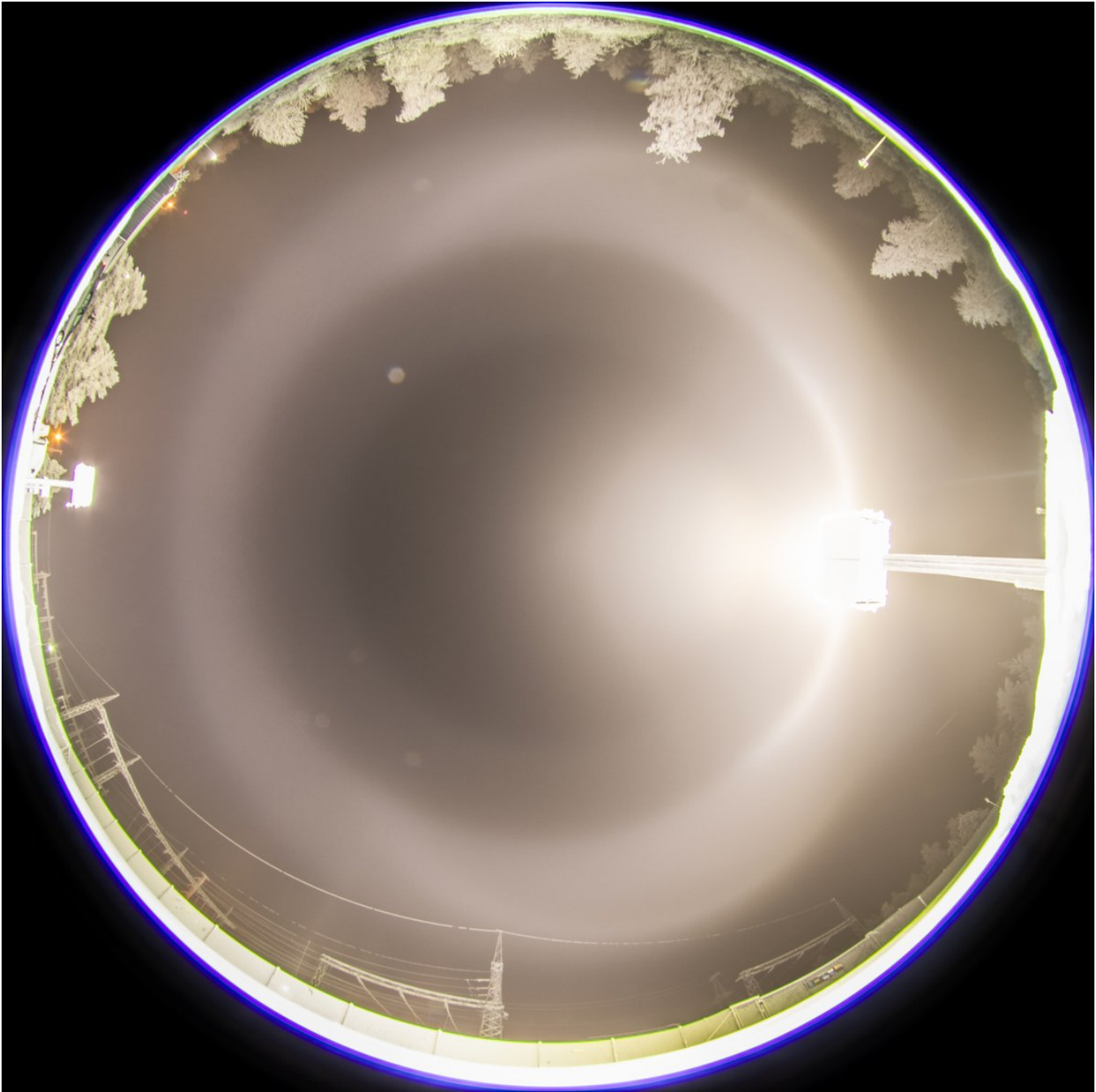


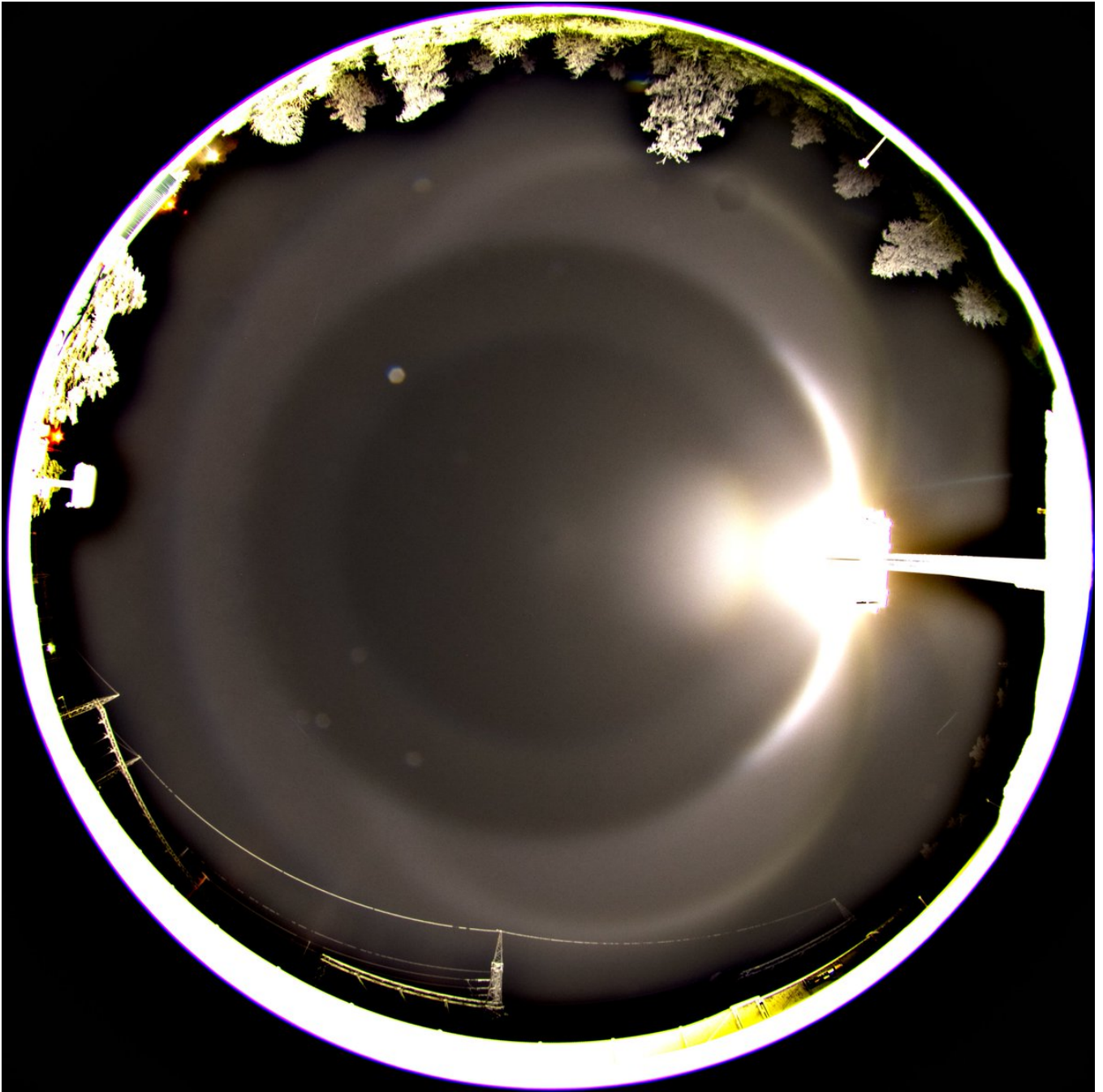


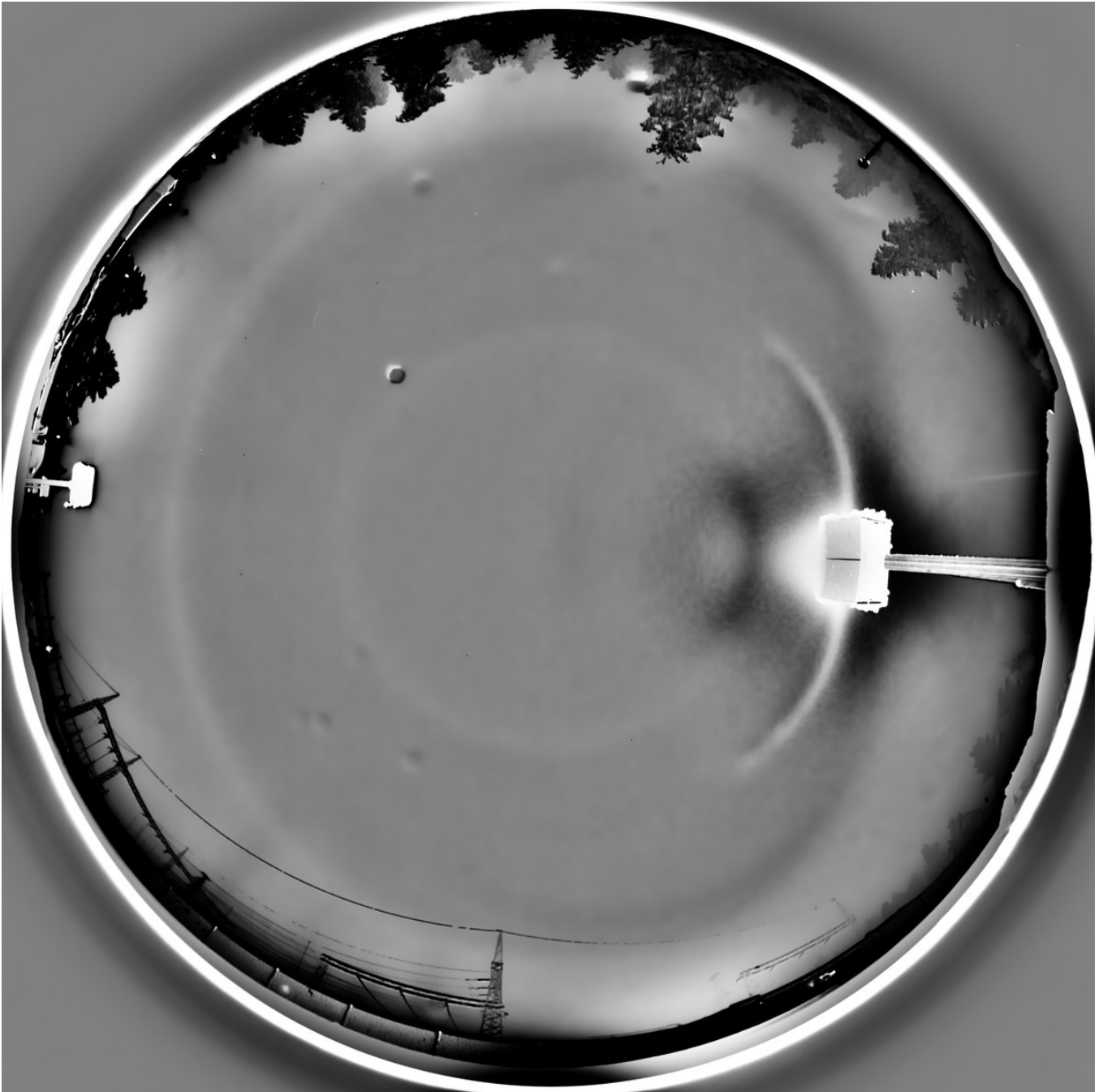
8/10 - 2026-02-14 14:17 UTC

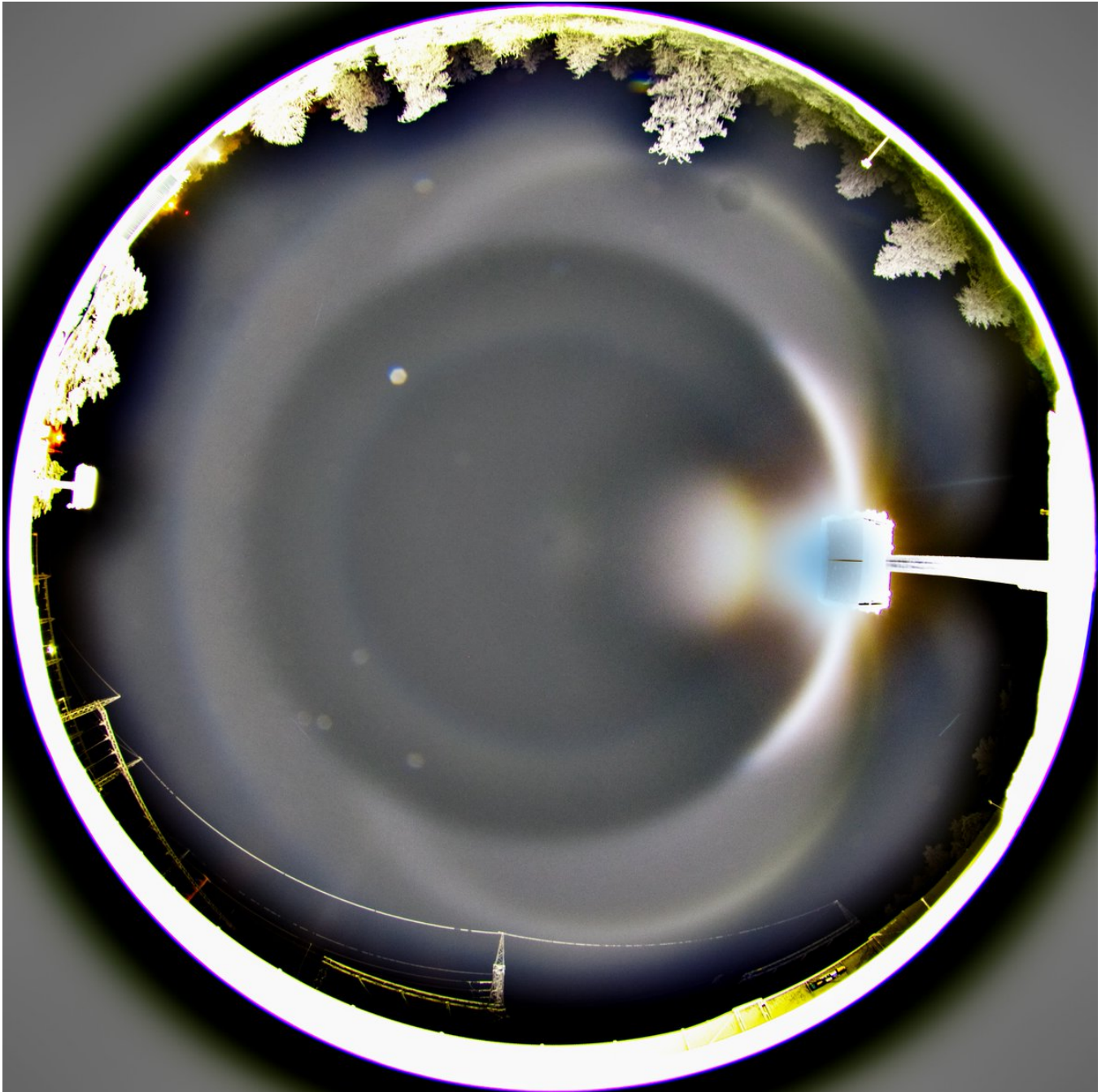
9/10 Feb 2026, Rovaniemi. This is 75 x 13s, of which above in this thread is shown a partial 19f stack of the best stage.

As to the duplicated cza seen in the photos taken with camera behind the second electric outlet pole, I think it's just divergent and classical instance mixed, the former making a broader arc, at the bottom of which is nested the latter narrower arc. That's the conclusion I came to after having brushed up myself on Lefaudeux's simulations.









9/10 - 2026-02-14 16:01 UTC

9/10 Feb 2026, Rovaniemi. Got this one shot of dive counterparhelia in the snow-reflected HID light before the swarm crapped. Towering high over you together with the countersun, they look visually really impressive.

Checking the memory card contents just now, I see I've got the crystals covered, too. They are quite good.



10/10 - 2026-02-14 22:42 UTC

9/10 Feb 2026, Rovaniemi. The very first stack of a basic looking display in which I visually noticed Moilanen in the flood. Stack materialized also 18° halo. This increases my confidence that the 18° halo I suspected two nights later is also real: <https://t.co/MKgwmw7OCL>

100 x 15s for ave. 14f in max.

